

Getting Around Edmonton When You Cannot Use the Bus

Two real doors: DATS, and the AISH transportation benefit. A plain-language guide.

If you cannot use a regular bus or LRT because of your disability, you have options, and you are allowed to use them. Here are two, and how they work together.

Door 1: DATS (Dedicated Accessible Transit Service)

A shared-ride, door-to-door public transit service for Edmonton residents who cannot use regular transit because of a physical or cognitive disability. You stay seated the whole way. You may also hear it called the Disabled Adult Transit Service.

Who qualifies: eligibility is decided case by case, based on whether your disability prevents you from using regular transit. It can cover all your trips, or only certain ones, for example winter only, and there is a temporary registration if your disability is temporary.

How to register

- 1 **Call to register.** Phone the DATS Client Service Centre at 780-496-4567, option 3, to check your eligibility and start. They will tell you which application form to send you.
 - 2 **Complete the form they send.** It includes a medical part, filled out by a health professional, confirming why you cannot use regular transit. Before you pay any fee for that, ask whether AISH will cover the cost.
 - 3 **Submit it as they direct.** Your application is reviewed to confirm your eligibility.
 - 4 **Once you are registered, book trips** at 780-496-4567, option 2, or by fax at 780-496-1008, up to 3 days ahead.
- Questions: 780-496-4567, or email dats@edmonton.ca. The DATS User Guide is at edmonton.ca/DATS.

One thing to know: a required attendant rides free with you, and applications are reviewed case by case. But not being able to use regular transit because of your disability is exactly what DATS is for.

Door 2: The AISH transportation benefit (for private drives)

AISH has personal benefits, money on top of your monthly amount for specific needs, and transportation to medical appointments can be covered at the most economical cost.

When a friend or roommate drives you: ask your worker how they reimburse a private driver, meaning mileage or fuel. The person helping you should not have to do it for free.

Ask your worker, and get the answer in writing. A note from your doctor saying you cannot safely use public transit turns your request from a story into documented need.

How they fit together: DATS gets you to appointments in a vehicle where you stay seated. The AISH transportation benefit covers the private drives you still need, so no one has to be your unpaid chauffeur. Between the two, getting to a doctor should never hang on whether a friend is free that day.

Verified against City of Edmonton (DATS) and Government of Alberta information, July 2026. Details can change, so confirm anything that affects you by phone.

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown — Advocate

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